

Slipper orchid



Stanhopea

These flowers blossom for only three days so have a strong scent to attract pollinator bees quickly.

Vanda



Nun orchid

Tubular petals lure insects inside.



Aerial roots collect water from moisture in the air.



These showy flowers are pollinated only by one species of butterfly.

White petals attract pollinators in spite of this flower's lack of nectar.



Red disa



Cattleya purpurata

Insects enter this pouchlike petal and are covered in pollen as they struggle to get out.

There are **28,000 known species** of orchids in the world.

platform for pollinators. **Oncidium** and **zygopetalum** flowers have particularly large lip petals, and in the **nun orchid** and **cattleya** flowers, these take the shape of colorful tubes. Orchids bundle their pollen into sticky packages, which attach to pollinators when they visit the flower. Some orchids can be pollinated only by a single species of insect—for the **red disa** orchid, for example, it is the mountain pride butterfly. This leaves the orchid very vulnerable. If the insect went extinct, the orchid would follow.